



HMO Feasibility Summary

Project: 13 Beech House Road, Croydon, CR0 1JQ

Client: Cliff Besley Reference: TH00205

1. Property and Location Overview

The subject property is a substantial period house arranged over four levels (basement, ground, first and second floors) on Beech House Road, a short walk east of Croydon town centre. The lawful use is a 6 bedroom HMO (Class C4), granted under reference 24/04169/FUL in May 2025. The property benefits from a very large rear garden.

The location is among the strongest in the borough for HMO use. East Croydon station is approximately 540 metres away (a 7 to 9 minute walk), providing Thameslink, Southern, Gatwick Express and Tramlink services. Public transport accessibility is estimated at PTAL 6a to 6b, the highest band. The street sits within the Central controlled parking zone, supporting a car free scheme.

The site is within the Chatsworth Road Conservation Area and the property is identified as a positive contributor in the adopted appraisal. It is not statutorily or locally listed. Large HMOs are an established feature of the street: Nos. 17 and 19 hold licences for substantial occupancy. Croydon has no adopted HMO density threshold, and a directly comparable 13 bedroom sui generis HMO was approved at 51 Addiscombe Road in 2022.

2. Proposed HMO Strategy

Target: 13 bedroom sui generis HMO, achieved through internal alterations only.

- All 13 bedrooms are en suite, with sizes from 12.6 sqm to 27 sqm against the Croydon en suite minimum of 12.5 sqm.
- No extensions are proposed. The existing four storey envelope absorbs the full scheme.
- The existing 6 bed C4 use provides the lawful baseline, so no family dwelling is lost.

Bedroom sizing

Bedrooms range from 12.6 sqm to 27 sqm, all above the Croydon standard. The basement provides two bedrooms of 19.2 sqm and 13 sqm with natural light. The second floor provides two large bedrooms of 27 sqm and 23.9 sqm. Every room takes a full en suite, which removes each occupant from the shared facility count under the Croydon ratios.

Amenity and kitchens

A 26 sqm kitchen and 13.8 sqm dining room on the ground floor form the communal hub, supported by a second kitchen on the second floor and a 9.1 sqm utility room. This provides the 3 kitchen sets required for 13 occupants, each within one floor of the bedrooms served.

- Approximately 40 sqm of internal communal space, around 3 sqm per occupant, at the top of the range accepted in recent Croydon approvals.



- The very large rear garden is retained in full as communal amenity space.

Existing fabric

The building requires no structural enlargement. Works are limited to internal partitioning, en suite formation, kitchen fit out and the staircase removal, which keeps cost, programme and planning risk down.

3. Design Opportunities and Key Constraints

Basement

Two bedrooms with windows and natural light, plus plant and storage. External clearance to basement windows to be confirmed at survey.

Ground floor

Four bedrooms, the kitchen and dining hub at the rear, utility room and entrance hall.

Upper floors

Five en suite bedrooms on the first floor (14.4 sqm to 17 sqm). Two large bedrooms and the second kitchen on the second floor.

External strategy

- No external alterations are proposed, which substantially limits the conservation area assessment.
- Bin and cycle storage to be screened and positioned to respect the conservation area frontage, with around 13 long stay and 2 short stay cycle spaces.
- The rear garden is retained without subdivision.

4. Planning Position and Risk

Principle of development

- The site is already a lawful HMO, so the proposal results in no loss of a protected family dwelling. Croydon officers applied exactly this logic to approve 6 Ledbury Road (2025).
- London Plan Policy H9 recognises HMOs as meeting local and strategic housing need and anchors every recent Croydon HMO approval.
- 51 Addiscombe Road (21/03943/FUL) is the lead precedent: a 13 bedroom sui generis HMO approved in 2022 in the same East Croydon high PTAL context, against 353 objections.
- Croydon has no adopted HMO density threshold. The established large HMOs at Nos. 17 and 19 demonstrate the use is an accepted feature of the street.

Key planning risk

The principal risk is political rather than policy based. The site is in a conservation area, ward councillors have opposed HMO schemes nearby (a 7 bed HMO at 10 Woodstock Road was refused at committee in May 2025), and a 13 bed application should be expected to attract



objections and committee determination. Croydon's HMO appeal record is poor, with no allowed HMO appeal identified since 2021, so the application must be designed to succeed at first determination.

Secondary risks

- **Parking:** a car free scheme with a Section 106 permit restriction is the expected route, consistent with all five comparable approvals. A sustainable transport contribution of around £1,500 per room is possible.
- **Accommodation standards:** fully mitigated by the en suite led layout, with all rooms above the 12.5 sqm standard and kitchen ratios met.
- **Conservation area:** mitigated by the internal only scope; frontage treatment of bins and cycles to be designed with care.
- **The May 2025 C4 permission** carries a Section 106 and conditions which should be reviewed before submission.

Professional view

The scheme is considered supportable. It aligns with the approved precedent pattern on every measurable point: lawful HMO baseline, internal only works, compliant room sizes, kitchen ratios, car free strategy and retained amenity. The recommended route is to confirm the sketch scheme with the client and proceed to planning drawings and a complete first time submission.

5. Building Regulations and Technical Compliance

Conversion to a 13 person HMO is a material change of use under the Building Regulations and triggers a full upgrade programme, not a light refurbishment.

Part B (Fire safety)

- 30 minute protected stair enclosure serving all four levels, fire doors with closers and smoke seals throughout.
- Interlinked detection (Grade A LD1 expected for a 13 person HMO) and emergency lighting to the escape route.
- A Fire Statement is also required with the planning application (London Plan Policy D12).

Part E (Acoustics)

- Sound insulation upgrades to walls and floors between bedrooms and to communal areas.

Part L (Thermal)

- Thermal upgrades to altered elements and an EPC of at least E for licensing, with C the prudent target.

Part F (Ventilation)

- The en suites are positioned internally and will require mechanical extract ventilation with appropriate ducting routes.
- Kitchen and utility extract provision to current standards.



Structural input will be required for the staircase removal and any load bearing wall alterations. These items are priced within the build cost benchmark below.

6. Commercial Position

Comparable en suite room rates in CR0 (SpareRoom, accessed June 2026, bills inclusive listings):

- East Croydon en suite doubles: £850, £895 and £1,100 per month.
- Wider Croydon en suite doubles: £950 to £995 per month, with a median around £945.

A rate of £900 per room per month is adopted as a conservative mid market figure for a new, fully en suite product in this location.

Indicative income: gross rent of £11,700 per month, £140,400 per year. Allowing 25 percent for operating costs, net annual income is approximately £105,300.

Indicative investment value: at an 8.5 percent yield the completed scheme supports a value in the order of £1.24m.

Indicative build cost: at a benchmark of £30,000 per bed plus a 10 percent allowance for the conservation area context, the conversion budget is approximately £429,000. This covers the full Part B, E, L and F upgrade, 13 en suites, kitchens, the staircase alteration and finishes.

All figures are indicative, sourced from public listings and standard benchmarks rather than client validated data, and are subject to measured survey, contractor pricing and valuation advice.

7. Key Next Steps

- Sketch proposals to be confirmed by the client, with planning drawings then instructed.
- A parking stress survey may be carried out to support the car free case.
- Measured survey to confirm room areas, ceiling heights and basement window clearances.
- Review the conditions and Section 106 attached to the May 2025 C4 permission and confirm the current HMO licence position.
- Develop the bin and cycle store design for the conservation area frontage.
- Prepare the application package: Design and Access Statement with heritage section, Planning Statement with density justification, HMO Standards compliance plan, Fire Statement, refuse and cycle strategy, and management strategy.



8. Conclusion

13 Beech House Road is a strong feasibility candidate. The 13 bedroom scheme is achieved entirely within the existing envelope, every bedroom is en suite and above the Croydon space standard, the kitchen and amenity provision sits at the top of the range accepted in recent approvals, and the very large rear garden adds a quality of amenity few comparable schemes can offer.

The planning case rests on an established lawful HMO baseline, a directly comparable 13 bed approval at 51 Addiscombe Road, the highest public transport accessibility band in the borough and an internal only scope that neutralises most conservation area risk. The principal residual risk is political, managed through a complete first time submission and pre application engagement.

Indicatively, a conversion budget in the order of £429,000 supports gross income of £140,400 per year and a completed value around £1.24m. The scheme is recommended to proceed at 13 bedrooms, with planning drawings instructed on client confirmation of the sketch proposals; the layout does not depend on pushing the envelope, and no higher bedroom count is recommended.